

SALT & WATER.

Electrolytes and fluid — without the “just drink more” slogan.

Water advice is usually reduced to a round number and a bottle. Salt advice is usually reduced to fear. The body runs on both fluid and sodium (with potassium and the rest of the electrolyte picture). Getting either chronically wrong shows up as flat energy, poor training, headaches, or the sense that something is “off” without a clear cause.

WHAT ACTUALLY MATTERS

Fluid: enough to replace what you lose through urine, breath, sweat, and stool — more when heat or training increases loss.

Sodium: required for nerve signalling, fluid balance, and blood volume. Heavily restricted diets plus high sweat loss is a common quiet problem.

Thirst is useful. It is not the only signal — especially once you are already behind.

PRACTICAL CUES

Urine that is consistently very dark suggests you are behind. Constantly clear and copious can mean you are overdoing plain water relative to electrolytes.

If you train hard, sweat heavily, or eat a very low-sodium pattern, plain water alone is sometimes not enough. A little salt with food, or an electrolyte source around long sessions, is ordinary physiology — not a biohack.

× COMMON FOLLY

- × **“Drink more water” as the only answer.** Flooding plain water while sodium is low can leave you feeling worse. Fluid and electrolytes travel together.
- × **Fear of all salt.** Population-level advice is not the same as the needs of a heavily training, sweating individual on a clean, low-processed diet. Context matters.
- × **Waiting until you are parched.** By the time thirst is loud during hard work, performance and cognition are often already down. Sip across the day; do not only chase the deficit.

SIMPLE LEVERS

Drink with meals. Drink around training. Add a pinch of salt to food if your diet is very plain and you sweat a lot. Notice energy, headaches, and how sessions feel when fluid and salt are more deliberate for a week.

WHAT THIS SHEET IS NOT

Not medical advice for blood pressure or kidney disease. Those conditions change the picture and need proper care. For generally healthy, active people, the fundamentals above are the usual starting point.

Next step: For one week, drink with meals and around training, and notice salt in ordinary food. Track energy and session quality. Free programme at beinghaware.github.io/BHAFL.